DEEPTI BABU

Certified Genetic Counselor | Medical Writer & Editor

CONTACTS

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St. Albert, Alberta T8N 5P6
Canada
(U.S. citizen/U.S. work-eligible)

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deeptigenetics@gmail.com

Website
deeptibabu.com

LinkedIn
linkedin.com/in/deeptibabu

Twitter
twitter.com/Deeptiwriting

EDUCATION

Master's in Human Genetics
Sarah Lawrence College
1997-1999

Bachelor's in Cell and Molecular Biology, Minor in Music
University of Washington
1992-1996

PROFILE

Experienced genetic counselor and skilled writing/editing consultant that offers over 20 years of clinical acumen across genetics specialties, merged with expertise in medical communications and marketing.

SKILLS HIGHLIGHTS (click here for testimonials)

- Leveraging broad clinical knowledge base and insights
- Architecting, managing, and completing multiple projects
- Writing, editing, and publishing clean content on time
- Leading cross-functional teams in changing environments
- Prioritizing and building frameworks in a dynamic landscape
- Building strong personal relationships
- Making and communicating difficult decisions

CERTIFICATIONS AND ADDITIONAL TRAINING

- American Board of Genetic Counseling, Inc. — 2002-present
- DIA Medical Communications Primer — Mar 2017
- AMA Content Marketing Bootcamp — Dec 2015

MEDICAL CONTENT/COMMUNICATIONS EXPERIENCE

Self-Employed — **St. Albert, Alberta (remote)**
Independent Consultant — Mar 2018-present
Partner with companies and organizations as an independent consultant for projects requiring medical writing/editing from someone with broad genetics/genomics expertise and comfort working with multiple audiences using different technologies. After brief onboarding, handle duties related to content approach, content creation, stakeholder engagement, content review, and deadline management with minimal oversight and direction needed. Sample work and feedback available at deeptibabu.com.

MEDICAL CONTENT/COMMUNICATIONS EXPERIENCE continued

ThinkGenetic, Inc. **St. Albert, Alberta (remote)**
Vice President, Communications and Patient Advocacy Jun 2017-Mar 2018
Ensured that communications (*e.g.* website, digital marketing), content, and relationships were valuable. Led team creating and configuring medical data for use an artificial intelligence (AI)-driven medical genetics diagnostic aid (ThinkGenetic SymptomMatcher™) for undiagnosed individuals. Curated web content used by patients, medical professionals, advocacy groups, and health consumers. Required exceptional clinical acumen and keen collaborations with development, marketing, contractors, and advocacy groups in a dynamic startup environment.

Ambry Genetics Corporation **St. Albert, Alberta (remote)**
Medical Communications Specialist Jan 2017-May 2017
Clinical Content Manager Apr 2016-Jan 2017
Clinical Content Editor (created position) Jul 2014-Apr 2016
Wrote/edited digital and print medical content via multiple channels and formats. Integrated and led many cross-functional teams to craft a consistent medical voice in a dynamic environment. Incepted company newsletter (>25% open rate; industry standard for marketing newsletters is ~18%). Chief Editor of patient blog and regular writer for corporate blog, engaging directly with internal and patient advocate contributors.

PATIENT-FACING GENETIC COUNSELING EXPERIENCE

Alberta Health Services **Edmonton, Alberta**
Certified Genetic Counsellor (part-time) Sep 2018-Sep 2019
A key resource in a temporary role, helping to develop a province-wide pilot that engages, educates, and supports clinicians providing pre-test information and genetic counseling to cancer patients. Will provide post-test clinical genetic counseling as needed after operational phase is reached. Integrating cross-functional teams to determine program priorities, strategies, troubleshooting, measurement, and sustainability across a large geographical region. Also creating educational resources for patients, clinicians, and staff.

Alberta Health Services and University of Alberta **Edmonton, Alberta**
Certified Genetic Counsellor (casual relief) May-Sep 2018
Certified Genetic Counsellor (permanent) Apr 2004-Jul 2014
Clinical Lecturer Jul 2009-Jul 2014
Clinical genetic counseling practice in tertiary care center with minimal oversight by clinical geneticists in multiple specialties. Handled tasks requiring keen clinical judgment and leadership. Asked to write departmental and clinical practice materials. Primary liaison to external groups; created interdisciplinary role with Cleft Lip/Palate Clinic. Taught medical students, residents, undergraduates, and genetic counseling interns.

Marshfield Clinic **Marshfield, Wisconsin**
Certified Genetic Counselor Sep 2000-Dec 2003
Institutional Review Board (IRB) Member Jun 2001-Jun 2003
Clinical genetic counseling practice in a tertiary care center with multiple clinical geneticists. Included outreach clinics, specialty clinics, NICU/Labor & Delivery/stillbirth consults, implementing a prenatal screening program, teaching residents/medical students. IRB member for full and expedited reviews.

Toronto-Sunnybrook Regional Cancer Centre **Toronto, Ontario**
Genetic Counsellor, Preventive Oncology Department Nov 1999-Sep 2000
Clinical genetic counseling practice in high-volume cancer center. Responsible for care with minimal administrative support and weekly meetings with off-site clinical geneticist. Ran weekly team Rounds.

PATIENT-FACING GENETIC COUNSELING EXPERIENCE continued

Lakeridge Health Oshawa **Oshawa, Ontario**
Genetic Counsellor Nov 1999-Sep 2000
First genetic counselor hired to develop prenatal and cancer genetics practice in a community hospital setting, including educational efforts. Consulted as necessary with off-site clinical geneticist.

North York General Hospital at Centenary Health Centre **Toronto, Ontario**
Genetic Counsellor, Regional Genetics Clinic Aug 1999-Sep 1999
Prenatal clinical genetic counseling practice in a high-volume clinic drawing from an extremely ethnically diverse population, working with other genetic counselors and off-site geneticist in an outreach setting.

Genetic Counseling Internships Sep 1997-May 1999

- Bridgeport Hospital Bridgeport, Connecticut
- Montefiore Medical Center Bronx, New York
- Hackensack University Medical Center Hackensack, New Jersey
- Louisiana State University at Children's Hospital New Orleans, Louisiana
- Nassau County Medical Center East Meadow, New York

WRITING AND EDITING EXPERIENCE (click here for samples)

Self-Employed **Edmonton, Alberta**
Freelance Writer and Editor Jan 2001-Mar 2018
External writer/editor for numerous companies and organizations on a project basis. Varied topics (e.g. medical, genomics, science, health, biotechnology, rare disease, patient advocacy, marketing, culinary) and formats for several audiences. More details are available at deeptibabu.com and linkedin.com/in/deeptibabu.

Venture Publishing, Inc. **Edmonton, Alberta**
Contract Writer Nov 2004-Dec 2015
Wrote medical and scientific pieces requiring research/interviews for lay publications in varying formats following minimal orientation. Required minimal oversight to write pieces requiring few edits on deadline.

HDBuzz **Various (remote)**
Staff Writer Jan 2011- May 2014
Wrote summaries of scientific research for a website keeping the worldwide public informed about international research on Huntington disease. Consistently met deadlines and wrote copy requiring few edits.

Genomic Strategy Consulting **Bluffton, South Carolina (remote)**
Director of Business Development, Senior Consultant Jun 2011-Jul 2012
Wrote promotional and educational scientific materials for clients needing to outsource genomics expertise, while also networking and building relationships. Produced highly rated materials on time with minimal edits needed.

***The Tomato* by BGP Publishing** **Edmonton, Alberta (remote)**
***City Palate* by BGP Publishing** **Edmonton, Alberta (remote)**
Freelance Writer May 2005-May 2011
Wrote personal memoir pieces on culinary and cultural experiences after independently planning, researching, and interviewing. Finished pieces on time, with each only needing minor edits.

WRITING AND EDITING EXPERIENCE continued

Growing Alberta **Edmonton, Alberta (remote)**
Freelance Writer Nov 2004-Jan 2006
Wrote pieces focusing on culinary themes for regional audience after researching and interviewing sources. Always respected deadlines and completed high-quality assignments on time.

Gale, a Cengage Company **Farmington Hills, Michigan (remote)**
Freelance Writer, Science Team Jan 2001-Apr 2005
Invited contributing independent author of genetic disease summaries to first and second editions of The Gale Encyclopedia of Genetic Disorders (GEGD) and The Gale Encyclopedia of Neurological Disorders textbooks. GEGD received Booklist/Reference Book Bulletin's "Editor's Choice of Outstanding Reference" and "CHOICE Outstanding Academic" titles for 2002.

Marshfield News-Herald **Marshfield, Wisconsin (remote)**
Wausau Daily Herald **Wausau, Wisconsin (remote)**
Food/Lifestyle Columnist (print) Sep 2002-Feb 2004
Created new food column with accompanying photos to explore culinary and cultural themes. Began with Marshfield regional newspaper and was successfully syndicated to a broader audience.

LEADERSHIP AND/OR EDITING EXPERIENCE

National Society of Genetic Counselors **Chicago, Illinois (remote)**
Director at Large, Board of Directors Jan 2018-present
Nominated to join Board of Directors for national genetic counseling organization. Tasked with setting and implementing strategic initiatives that impact the membership, practice, and the profession.

National Society of Genetic Counselors **Chicago, Illinois (remote)**
Finance Committee Member Jan 2019-present
Nominated to join Finance Committee for national genetic counseling organization. Tasked with reviewing budget requests and proposals brought forward for financial consideration and decisions.

National Society of Genetic Counselors **Chicago, Illinois (remote)**
Genetic Counseling Standards Task Force Member Jun 2016-present
Nominated to join group of genetic counselor leaders with expertise in policy development and research to create standards for reporting genetic counseling activities in research. Journal of Genetic Counseling publication resulted from this work.

National Society of Genetic Counselors **Chicago, Illinois (remote)**
Conflict of Interest (COI) Task Force Member Jun 2016-present
Nominated to join group of genetic counselor leaders with expertise in COI to craft recommendations and educational tools to help membership identify and manage COI in their practices.

Canadian Association of Genetic Counsellors **Oakville, Ontario (remote)**
Co-Editor and Member, *Crossover* Jan 2014-Dec 2017
Selected to co-lead transformation of national organization's newsletter to digital publication with minimal support, integrating Board and member input. >53% open rate (industry standard for medical newsletters is ~22%).

LEADERSHIP AND/OR EDITING EXPERIENCE continued

National Society of Genetic Counselors **Chicago, Illinois (remote)**
Chair, Practice Guidelines Committee Jan 2014-Dec 2016
Nominated to chair interdisciplinary group that oversees development of genetic counseling practice guidelines (CPGs). Over 3-year rotation, led process of transitioning the entire process of developing CPGs to one that is evidence-based, including downloadable process manual integrating Board and member input.

National Society of Genetic Counselors **Chicago, Illinois (remote)**
Committee Member, *Perspectives in Genetic Counseling* Jan 2013-Dec 2018
Executive Editor, *Perspectives in Genetic Counseling* Jan 2009-Dec 2013
Selected to edit national professional organization's newsletter, including leading a team to transform to a digital magazine. >35% open rate (industry standard for medical newsletters is ~22%).

LABORATORY RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Oak Ridge National Laboratory **Oak Ridge, Tennessee**
Senior Research Assistant Jul 1996-Jul 1997
Performed basic lab work to further research into inborn errors of metabolism. Actively participated in regular Journal Club meetings.

SCIENTIFIC ABSTRACTS

Loucopoulos G, Laney D, Simmons M, **Babu D**, Bellcross C, Garber K. Assessing the disease specific knowledge gaps in patients and caregivers living with lysosomal storage diseases. Poster, National Society of Genetic Counselors Annual Conference, 2018.

Ogg C, Mitchell T, Simmons M, **Babu D**, Wilkerson PL, Laney D. Decreasing the diagnosis odyssey of patients living with Fabry disease via ThinkGenetic SymptomMatcher™. Poster, WORLDSymposium, 2018.

Bergner A, **Babu D**, Cummings S, Hahn S, McWalter K, Tan C. Understanding characteristics of industry genetic counselors to inform ongoing workforce discussions. Poster, National Society of Genetic Counselors Annual Conference, 2017.

Bergner A and **Babu D**. Characteristics of genetic counselors in industry-based roles: Considerations for ongoing workforce discussions. Poster, American College of Medical Genetics and Genomics Annual Meeting, 2017.

Babu D, Klotz CM, Witol AD. A leader-led compassion fatigue support group for genetic counsellors. Poster, National Society of Genetic Counsellors Annual Education Conference, 2012. Poster, Canadian Association of Genetic Counsellors Annual Education Conference, 2012.

Giampietro PF, **Babu D**, Koehn MA, Jacobson DM, Mueller-Schrader KA, Moretti C, Patten SF, Shaffer LG, Gorlin RJ, Peng Y, Dobyns WB. New syndrome with focal dermal hypoplasia, follicular hamartomas, polysyndactyly, microphthalmia, morning glory optic disc anomaly, partial agenesis of the corpus callosum and polymicrogyria. Poster, American Society of Human Genetics Annual Meeting, 2002.

SCIENTIFIC PUBLICATIONS

Gordon ES, **Babu D**, Laney DA. The future is now: technology's impact on the practice of genetic counseling. Am J Med Genet C. 2018. doi: 10.1002/ajmg.c.315999.

Hooker GW, **Babu D**, Myers M, Zierhut H, McAllister M. Standards for the reporting of genetic counseling interventions in research and other studies (GCIRS): An NSGC Task Force Report. J Genet Coun. 2017. doi: 10.1007/s10897-017-0076-9.

Jorgez CJ, Rosenfeld JA, Wilken NR, Vangapandu HV, Sahin A, Pham D, Carvalho CM, Bandholz A, Miller A, Weaver DD, Burton B, **Babu D**, Bamforth JS, Wilks T, Flynn DP, Roeder E, Patel A, Cheung SW, Lupski JR, Lamb DJ. Genitourinary defects associated with genomic deletions in 2p15 encompassing *OTX1*. PLoS One. 2014. doi: 10.1371/journal.pone.0107028.

Moore MW, **Babu D**, Cotter PD. Challenges in the codevelopment of companion diagnostics. Pers Med. 2012. doi: 10.2217/pme.12.60.

Moore MW, **Babu D**, Cotter PD. Companion diagnostics and personalized medicine: A review of molecular diagnostic applications. Curr Top Genet. 2012; 5:23-30.

Cotter PD, **Babu D**, Moore MW. A new paradigm for personalized medicine and companion diagnostics: The Contract Diagnostics Organization. Open Conf Proceed J. 2012; 3:52-58.

Ballif BC, Rosenfeld JA, Traylor R, Theisen A, Bader PI, Ladda RL, Sell SL, Steinraths M, Surti U, McGuire M, Williams S, Farrell SA, Filiano J, Schnur RE, Coffey LB, Tervo RC, Stroud T, Marble M, Netzloff M, Hanson K, Aylsworth AS, Bamforth JS, **Babu D**, Niyazov DM, Ravnan JB, Schultz RA, Lamb AN, Torchia BS, Bejjani BA, Shaffer LG. High-resolution array CGH defines critical regions and candidate genes for microcephaly, abnormalities of the corpus callosum, and seizure phenotypes in patients with microdeletions of 1q43q44. Hum Genet. 2012. doi: 10.1007/s00439-011-1073-y. Wakeman B, MacDonald IM, Ginjarr I, Tarleton J, **Babu D**. Extraocular muscle hypertrophy in myotonia congenita: Mutation identified in the SCN4A gene (V445M). J AAPOS. 2009. doi: 10.1016/j.jaapos.2009.07.001.

Wakeman B, **Babu D**, Tarleton J, MacDonald IM. Extraocular muscle hypertrophy in myotonia congenita. J AAPOS. 2008. doi: 10.1016/j.jaapos.2007.12.002.

Giampietro PF, **Babu D**, Zabel CA, Silberman T, Zador I, DeBauche D, Ravnan JB, Dave BJ. Novel clinical features in a child with partial deletion of chromosome 11 [del(11)(q24.2)]: further evidence for phenotypic heterogeneity. Am J Med Genet. 2006. doi: 10.1002/ajmg.a.31067.

Giampietro PF, **Babu D**, Koehn MA, Jacobson DM, Mueller-Schrader KA, Moretti C, Patten SF, Shaffer LG, Gorlin RJ, Dobyns WB. New syndrome: focal dermal hypoplasia, morning glory anomaly, and polymicrogyria. Am J Med Genet. 2004 Jan 15;124A(2):202-8.

PROFESSIONAL SOCIETY ENGAGEMENT

- American Board of Genetic Counseling 2002-present
- National Society of Genetic Counselors 1996-present
- Canadian Association of Genetic Counsellors 2014-2018

INVITED TEACHING AND SPEAKING ENGAGEMENTS

Augustana-Sanford Genetic Counseling Program (Sioux Falls, South Dakota)	2018
Indiana Network of Genetic Counselors (Indianapolis, Indiana)	2017
National Society of Genetic Counselors Annual Education Conference (Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania)	2015
Medical Laboratory Sciences 480 course (Edmonton, Alberta)	2007-2015
College of Registered Dental Hygienists of Alberta Annual Continuing Competence Event (Calgary, Alberta)	2014
University of Alberta Dental Hygienists Study Club (Edmonton, Alberta)	2012
Canadian Association of Genetic Counsellors (Saskatoon, Saskatoon)	2012
Primary Supervisor for Genetic Counseling student – summer internship (Edmonton, Alberta)	2012
Speech-Language Pathologists Rounds (Edmonton, Alberta)	2010
Primary Supervisor for Genetic Counseling student – summer internship (Edmonton, Alberta)	2008
"Practical Genetics for Health Care Providers," conference (Wisconsin Dells, Wisconsin)	2008
Canadian Association of Genetic Counsellors Annual Education Conference (Vancouver, British Columbia)	2007
Hereditary Breast and Ovarian Cancer Society of Alberta (Edmonton, Alberta)	2005, 2007
Canadian National Institute for the Blind (Edmonton, Alberta)	2004
Pediatrics, Internal Medicine, Surgery, Med/Peds resident lectures (Marshfield, Wisconsin)	2001-2003
Various Marshfield Clinic departments and regional centers (Marshfield, Wisconsin)	2001-2003
University of Wisconsin (Marshfield, Wisconsin)	2002-2003
"Practical Genetics for Primary Care Providers" conference (Wisconsin Dells, Wisconsin)	2002-2003
Various high schools throughout central/northern Wisconsin	2001-2003
"27th Annual Winter Pediatrics Seminar" conference (Wakefield, Michigan)	2003
Genealogy Group meeting (Marshfield, Wisconsin)	2003
Elderhostel group annual conference (Marshfield, Wisconsin)	2003
Mid-State Technical College (Marshfield, Wisconsin)	2002
Medical Appointment coordinators meeting (Marshfield, Wisconsin)	2001
Gluten Intolerance support group meeting (Marshfield, Wisconsin)	2001
Cancer & Holistic Health Fair (Wausau, Wisconsin)	2001
Ethics: The Genetic (R)Evolution conference (Marshfield, Wisconsin)	2001
Medical Transcriptionists meeting (Marshfield, Wisconsin)	2001
Certified Medical Assistants quarterly meeting (Marshfield, Wisconsin)	2000

PERSONAL REFERENCES

- Available upon request

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Writing/Editing/Management/Speaking Highlights

Clinical/Medical Professional Audience

- Research study summaries with take-home points (print, web, blog)
- Quarterly e-collection of Ambry Genetics research (file available if needed)
- Newsletters (files available if needed)
  - Corporate

    Ambry Genetics and ThinkGenetic newsletters
  - Professional society (led both teams to transform publication to digital format)

    Executive Editor: National Society of Genetic Counselors' (NSGC's) newsletter

    Co-Editor: Canadian Association of Genetic Counsellors' newsletter
- Educational material, brochures, genetic counseling aids, guideline summaries, clinical management resources, referral indications (more examples available if needed)
  - Newer versions available at http://www.ambrygen.com/clinician/resources/clinical-materials
- Clinical policy/guidance documents (files available if needed)
  - New program for NSGC's evidence-based clinical practice guidelines
  - New materials for NSGC members about conflict of interest
  - New standards for reporting genetic counseling activities in research (*Journal of Genetic Counseling* publication)
- Letter of Medical Necessity templates
  - https://www.ambrygen.com/clinician/forms
- Webinars
  - Guidelines International Network "Guideline Development for Non-Physician Clinicians": http://www.g-i-n.net/library/webinars/g-i-n-n-a-webinars/gin-na-webinar-29-june-2017
  - Speaker manager: http://www.ambrygen.com/clinician/webinar/27/a-cross-border-conversion-clinical-approaches-to-hereditary-cancer-panel-use
- Research publications/abstracts/posters, textbook chapters

Patient and Health Consumer Audiences

- Natural language processing of medical content for SymptomMatcher™, a web-based diagnostic aid powered by artificial intelligence/machine learning. Also managed contract medical writers.
    - https://www.thinkgenetic.com/SymptomMatcher/
- Online hereditary cancer risk calculator
    - https://risk.ambrygen.com/
- Blog posts
    - Editor (reviewed posts, solicited authors)

      https://news.thinkgenetic.com/2017/09/27/resilience-the-art-of-caregiving-preparing-for-curves-bumps-and-wrong-turns-by-adding-a-dose-of-resilience/
    - Chief Editor (solicited and managed patient authors/content calendar, reviewed posts)

      http://blog.ambrygen.com/patient/post/52/in-the-beginning-my-ovaries-were-talking-but-i-wasn-t-listening
- Videos:
    - https://www.ambrygen.com/patient/genetics-101
- Educational websites
    - Q&A content using IBM Watson® framework. Also managed contract medical writers. Sample entry: https://www.thinkgenetic.com/diseases/barth-syndrome-8516/overview/36621
    - https://www.ambrygen.com/patient/resources-and-support
- Patient educational brochures (sample below)
    - Clinical Genomics Patient Guide: https://www.ambrygen.com/file/material/view/966/Patient_Guide_ClinicalGenomics_0818_web.pdf
- Advocacy Partner Program
    - Collaborated with advocacy groups in ongoing partner program

      Program partners: https://news.thinkgenetic.com/advocacy-partner-program/

      Writing patient stories for SymptomMatcher™ diagnostic aid

Clinical/Patient/Consumer Audiences

- Blog posts
    - "Real world" summaries of company research

      http://blog.ambrygen.com/ambry/post/175/current-genetic-testing-guidelines-miss-some-families-with-cdh1-mutations

- Blog posts (continued)
  - "Real world" summaries of company research

    http://blog.ambrygen.com/ambry/post/3/exome-sequencing-provides-more-coverage-than-you-think
  - Direct-to-consumer vs. medical-grade genetic testing (including table content):

    http://blog.ambrygen.com/ambry/post/188/how-are-direct-to-consumer-and-medical-grade-genetic-tests-different
  - Genetic testing for patients with hematologic cancer:

    http://blog.ambrygen.com/ambry/post/171/can-patients-with-hematological-cancer-have-genetic-
  - Conference summary/company promotion:

    https://news.thinkgenetic.com/2017/09/22/harnessing-the-power-within-at-the-national-society-of-genetic-counselor-2017-conference/
- Press releases
  - http://www.ambrygen.com/about/press-release/74/ambry-genetics-to-present-seven-abstracts-at-upcoming-acmg-annual-clinical-genetics-meeting
- Social media posts/images
  - Facebook, Twitter, LinkedIn, Instagram
- Speaking engagements (examples available if needed)

Website
deeptibabu.com

LinkedIn
linkedin.com/in/deeptibabu

Twitter
twitter.com/Deeptiwriting

Skills to consider for projects:

- Broad medical genetics expertise suited to clinical genomics
- Extrapolating key points from dense starting material
- Pivoting between media formats/ channels
- Managing priorities in dynamic areas
- Comfort with technology
- Building relationships
- Fostering communication and understanding
- Engaging and integrating relevant stakeholders
- Respecting deadlines